

A PROJECT REPORT ON
DECEPTIVE ENDORSEMENTS OF SKINCARE PRODUCTS
CAUSING ETHICAL CONCERNS AMONGST FEMALE YOUTH IN
AHMEDABAD.

SUBMITTED BY:
“ELITE ETHICS”
BATCH 2024-2025

SUBMITTED TO:
L.J. INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION,
VASTRAPUR, AHMEDABAD



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Project report submitted in the partial fulfilment of the
Degree of

Bachelor of Business Administration

SEMESTER VI

Submitted By:

Sr. No.	NAME	ROLL NO.	Sr. No.	NAME	ROLL NO.
1	CHAUHAN HARSHAL	20	6	PRAJAPTI MEET	91
2	VAVADIYA VIDHI	140	7	PRAJAPATI HARDIK	89
3	JODHPURA VRAJ	43	8	BAORT RIYA	08
4	PATEL RACHIT	87	9	MISTRY JIYA	63
5	MODI VANSI	65	10	PANCHAL KHUSHALI	68

Under the guidance of:

Dr. Rupal Shah

Prof. Aashini Shah

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Prof. Nilesh Pandya

Prof. Jainam Shah

Submitted to:



LJ INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

CERTIFICATE

This is to clarify that the project report on

“DECEPTIVE ENDORSEMENTS OF SKINCARE PRODUCTS CAUSING ETHICAL CONCERNS AMONGST FEMALE YOUTH IN AHMEDABAD.”

Has been submitted by the students of **Semester-6 to**

“LJ INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION”

For the year 2024-2025 in partial fulfillment of **GUJARAT UNIVERSITY**

requirement for the degree of **BBA**

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DIRECTOR _____.

PROJECT INCHARGE _____.

EXTERNAL EVALUATER _____.

PLACE: AHMEDABAD

DATE:

PREFACE

With Rising integration of Internet and Commerce, to be precise digital marketing & E-commerce. The difference between an endorsement and a deceptive endorsement has been narrowed down in past few years giving rise to Ethical Concerns for the customer- seller- Manufacturer relationship.

Especially in the Skincare Products Industry targeting female youth as the overall skincare market in India is projected to reach **USD 4.11 billion in 2025.**

This report was prepared as a part of the curriculum of **BBA** programme of the **Gujarat university**. As a part of this project, we were supposed to conduct a survey of 200 people through Questionnaire. Through this survey we came to know about various types of endorsements and their psychological, physiological, sociological etc. effects on Female Youth in Ahmedabad.

Subject matter of this report has been elaborated with simple words and lucid explanation and reasoning. Tables, Charts, Figures, Graphs etc. have been used to facilitate understanding. We gave our best efforts to make the project valuable , useful and interesting to it's readers.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

On this great occasion of accomplishment of our project on “**DECEPTIVE ENDORSEMENTS OF SKINCARE PRODUCTS CAUSING ETHICAL CONCERNS AMONGST FEMALE YOUTH IN AHMEDABAD**”, we would like to sincerely express our gratitude to **Dr. Rupal Shah, Prof. Aashini Shah and Prof. Nilesh Pandya** who has been supportive throughout the completion of this project.

We would also be thankful to other professors and “**LJ INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION**” for providing all the required facilities in completion of the project.

Finally, we would especially like to thank all the respondents for their support during the research work. We extend our sincere thanks to all. . .

Yours Sincerely,

Sr. No.	NAME	ROLL NO.	Sr. No.	NAME	ROLL NO.
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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that the project titled “**DECEPTIVE ENDORSEMENTS OF SKINCARE PRODUCTS CAUSING ETHICAL CONCERNS AMONGST FEMALE YOUTH IN AHMEDABAD**” is original to the best of our knowledge and has not been published elsewhere. This project is prepared for the purpose of partial fulfilment for the award of BBA as per the requirement of **GUJARAT UNIVERSITY**.

Sr. No.	NAME	ROLL NO.	SIGN.	Sr. No.	NAME	ROLL NO.	SIGN
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CHAPTER I: INTRODUCTION

INTRODUCTION

[1.1] BACKGROUND:

The skincare industry has seen a significant transformation with the rise of influencer marketing (product endorsements by influencer). Influencers, often referred to as "skinfluencers," have become pivotal in shaping consumer choices, especially among the youth. These influencers, who may lack formal dermatological qualifications, often promote skincare products through social media platforms like Instagram and YouTube. While their endorsements create a sense of trust and relatability, they often lack scientific validation, raising critical concerns about product safety and consumer protection.

In Ahmedabad, the impact of deceptive endorsements is particularly pronounced among female youth. Young women, influenced by social media trends and celebrity endorsements, are increasingly relying on these influencers for skincare advice. However, the lack of professional expertise among influencers can lead to the promotion of products that may not be suitable for all skin types, potentially causing adverse effects. This reliance on non-professional endorsements poses significant risks, as young women may make impulsive purchasing decisions without proper evaluation.

[1.2] RATIONALE FOR THE STUDY

- Understanding the dynamics of influencer marketing and its impact on consumer behaviour is crucial for addressing the ethical concerns.
- By examining the practices of skin influencers and their influence on consumer choices, we can unravel the challenges and opportunities inherent in this rapidly evolving landscape.
- The ethical concerns surrounding deceptive endorsements are further exacerbated by the cultural and societal pressures faced by female youth in Ahmedabad.
- The desire to achieve flawless skin and conform to beauty standards can lead to the exploitation of trust and the promotion of unhealthy products. This situation calls for stricter regulations and increased consumer awareness to ensure that young women are making informed decisions about their skincare routines.

[1.3] OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY:

- To **assess** the impact of these deceptive endorsements on the purchasing decisions and trust of the target demographic.
- To **measure** the awareness levels among female youth regarding deceptive marketing practices and their perceptions of influencer credibility.
- To **study** the accountability measures influencers currently take and suggest improvements to enhance transparency.
- To **evaluate** the effectiveness of current regulations and the need for stricter controls to protect consumers from deceptive practices.

[1.4] SCOPE OF STUDY:

➤ **Geographic Focus:**

The main geographical location of this study is Ahmedabad, Gujarat, India. The cosmetic industry in Ahmedabad has emerged as fastest growing industry after food industry, therefore this study will explore the local dynamics of impact of deceptive endorsements on consumer decision and trust.

➤ **Time Frame:**

The study will take a comprehensive time frame, taking data and innovation of marketing practices in last ten years. This extended time frame allows for a detailed analysis and accuracy of findings and conclusion.

➤ **Industry Focus:**

The main sector under consideration is the Skincare sector of the cosmetic industry. This research will explore how endorsements which are deceptive affects business dynamics in the industry

[1.5] KEY TERMINOLOGY

Following terminologies will help you to understand the following research better.

- **Skinfluencer**: An influencer who specializes in skincare and beauty, often providing product recommendations, reviews, and skincare routines.
- **Deceptive Endorsement**: A marketing practice where an influencer or celebrity promotes a product in a misleading way, exaggerating its benefits or concealing its drawbacks.
- **Ethical Concerns**: Moral issues and dilemmas that arise in marketing practices, including honesty, transparency, and the potential harm to consumers.
- **Beauty Standards**: Societal norms and expectations regarding physical appearance, often influencing consumer behavior and self-esteem.
- **Dermatological Expertise**: Professional knowledge and qualifications related to the study and treatment of skin conditions, often lacking in influencer endorsements.

- **Impulse Purchasing**: The act of buying products without prior planning, often influenced by emotional triggers and marketing strategies.
- **Consumer Awareness**: The knowledge and understanding that a buyer should have about a product before making a purchase, including its benefits, risks, and authenticity.
- **Transparency**: The practice of being open and honest about the nature of marketing practices, including sponsorships and endorsements.

[1.6] FUTURE OUTLOOK

In coming 10 years the landscape of skincare product endorsements and the ethical concerns surrounding them are likely to evolve which are as follows:

- **Increased Regulation and Transparency:** As awareness of deceptive endorsements grows, regulatory bodies may impose stricter guidelines on influencer marketing. This could include mandatory disclosure of sponsorships and clearer guidelines on what constitutes deceptive advertising.
- **Consumer Education:** Efforts to educate consumers about the potential pitfalls of deceptive endorsements will increase. This could involve campaigns to raise awareness about the importance of critical thinking and researching products independently.
- **Technological Advancements:** The use of technology, such as AI-driven personalized skincare solutions, will become more prevalent. This will help consumers make more informed decisions based on their unique skin needs rather than relying solely on influencer recommendations.
- **Sustainable and Ethical Products:** There will be a growing demand for skincare products that are not only

effective but also ethically produced and environmentally friendly. Brands that prioritize sustainability and ethical practices will gain a competitive edge.

- **Collaboration with Dermatologists:** Brands may collaborate more with dermatologists and skincare professionals to ensure that their products are safe and effective. This will help build trust with consumers and reduce the risk of deceptive endorsements.

[1.7] EXTENT

This survey is done in Ahmedabad city.

[1.8] DURATION

We did this survey and completion of the study in period of 6 months.

[1.9] SAMPLE SIZE

We did this survey with 200 responses of female youth in Ahmedabad.

CHAPTER II: LITERATURE REVIEW

LITERATURE REVIEW

The skincare industry has witnessed significant growth in recent years, with companies employing various marketing strategies to promote their products. One such strategy of influencer endorsements, which have become increasingly popular in India. However, there is growing concern amongst female youth in Ahmedabad about the deceptive nature of these endorsements, which can lead to unethical marketing practices.

According to research by Escalas and Bettman (2003), young consumers are more likely to emulate celebrities and influencers due to their aspirational appeal. For female youth in Ahmedabad, exposure to such endorsements through social media platforms like Instagram and YouTube often leads to the internalization of beauty ideals and unrealistic expectations.

According to the study of Williams & Polonsky, 2006; It show that deceptive marketing practices have been increasingly used to exploit consumers' insecurities, particularly around appearance, leading to higher sales but also significant.

Deceptive endorsements are defined as marketing practices that promote false claims about a product's effectiveness. In the skincare industry, this often includes promises of instant results, unrealistic skin improvements, or celebrity testimonials that may not reflect genuine experiences, this study is done by Choi & Rifon, 2007.

Studies suggest that educating young consumers about media literacy and the potential harms of deceptive advertising can help mitigate the impact of these endorsements (Kirmani & Zhu, 2007).

A growing body of literature emphasizes the need for increased consumer awareness and regulation of deceptive marketing practices. Ethical marketing, which involves transparent communication about product benefits and limitations, has become a key area of focus in recent discussions about consumer protection in the skincare industry (Crane & Matten, 2007).

Studies have shown that influencer endorsements can be misleading, with many celebrities endorsing products they do not use or believe in (Huddlers et al., 2012).

A survey conducted in India found that 70% of respondents believed that celebrity endorsements were not genuine (Sinha et al., 2017).

The ethical concerns extend beyond consumer deception and include the broader impact on societal beauty standards. In Ahmedabad, the promotion of fairness creams, anti-aging products, and acne treatments that promise immediate results are prevalent. This not only perpetuates colourism and unrealistic beauty norms but also diminishes self-esteem among young women (Desai & Shah, 2019).

The Indian government and regulatory bodies such as the Advertising Standards Council of India (ASCI) have begun addressing deceptive endorsements. Recent regulations call for greater transparency and accountability in advertising skincare products, especially those targeting young consumers (ASCI, 2021). However, enforcement remains a challenge, and deceptive practices continue to proliferate, particularly on social media platforms where regulations are more difficult to monitor.

In Ahmedabad beauty ideals increasingly dominate the skincare market, local female youth are particularly susceptible to these pressures. This can lead to negative body image, dissatisfaction with one's appearance, and unhealthy behaviours such as excessive product use (Bhatt, 2020).

According to Jones & Glynn 'study (2021), Several studies have shown that female youth, particularly teenagers, are vulnerable to marketing tactics that play on their insecurities about appearance .

In 2022 Kapoor et al.'s study says that Celebrity and influencer endorsements play a crucial role in shaping consumer preferences, especially among younger audiences.

In Ahmedabad, local campaigns promoting self-acceptance and challenging unrealistic beauty standards are gaining traction, providing a counter-narrative to the deceptive marketing of skincare products (Kumar, 2023).

The marketing of skincare products often targets demographics youth, including young females, promoting unrealistic beauty standards that can adversely affect mental health (Madhumita & Ponnarasu, 2024).

Ethical violations in marketing practices, particularly in low- and middle-income countries, necessitate stricter regulations to protect young consumers (Madhumita & Ponnarasu, 2024).

CHAPTER III: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

[3.1] RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

INTRODUCTION:

The analytical technique used is Large sample test and Spearman Rank correlation which were appropriate as per our Questionnaire and objectives. We surveyed 200 female youth in Ahmedabad through google forms. Research analysis was performed in Gamovi.

Type of research:

- **Descriptive:**

The study will describe the awareness levels, perceptions, and behaviors of female youth regarding deceptive skincare product endorsements. It will collect data on their experiences, attitudes, and the extent of certain behaviors by conducting surveys.

DATA COLLECTION SOURCES

The collected data should be appropriate and adequate, hence to be collected by two methods e.g., primary and secondary.

- **Primary data: -**

This data shown that the information was collected through a survey, which is primary data, from 200 female youth in Ahmedabad. Surveys are a crucial part of quantitative research.

- **Secondary data: -**

Secondary data was collected from internet sources, journals, magazines, pamphlets, textbooks, and journals. It is an efficient method that allowed me to acquire the relevant information in less time and with lesser resources.

- **Tools analysis:**

The descriptive survey method were used to collect the data about the features, expectations, satisfaction, problems etc. the customers.

- **Statistical tools used**

- **Spearman's rank correlation:**

Spearman's rank correlation is a nonparametric measure of statistical dependence between two random variables. It evaluates how the relationship between two variables can be described by means of a monotonic function. Unlike with Pearson's correlation, which measures linear relationships, Spearman's correlation focuses on the rank order of the data rather than their actual values.

- **Test 5 proportion z test:**

Z-Test is a method of statistical determination that allows researchers to differentiate at a certain level of significance between the proportions of a specific characteristic in two independent groups.

- **Project design:**

This mixed-methods study concerns deceptive skincare advertising and ethical issues among 200 young women of Ahmedabad. Surveys will measure exposure, purchasing, and ethics; focus groups/interviews will measure perceptions and emotional reactions. An integrated analysis will help to find out the comprehensive idea.

SAMPLING DESIGN

Simple random sampling is a probability sampling method in which every member of a population has an equal chance of being included in the sample, making the selection of this subset representative of the larger group and minimizing bias in research; in essence, it consists of randomly selecting individuals from a population without any systematic preference for any of the members.

- **Selection of Sample:**

To establish the validity and reliability of the findings, a sample of young women in Ahmedabad was chosen. Ideally, a

sample size would represent a percentage of the total population of young women in Ahmedabad. However, for the purpose of this research project, an appropriate manageable yet robust sample size of 200 respondents was decided.

- **Sampling Unit:**

The sampling unit for this study will be young women residing in Ahmedabad who consume skincare products and are exposed to skincare product endorsements.

- **Sampling Size:**

The sample size for this current study covered 200 young women in Ahmedabad.

PURPOSE OF QUESTIONNAIRE:

- The first stage of the study deals with consumer behavior, that is to say, the relationship between influencers' endorsements and the financial and brand choices made by female youth.
- Its second aim lies in assessing the awareness with regards to false promotions and the credibility of influencers in the skincare industry.
- Perceptions Related to Ethics are about exploring how the target demographics define the ethics problems related to endorsements of skincare products.
- Informational Structures and Imposition of Control deal with looking at the concept of evaluating the present regulation and the imposition of accountability in cases of influencers and brands engaged in deceptive marketing practices.
- It allows the respondents ample time to consider their answers without the interference of the interviewer.
- Cost-effective method for reaching a large number of people simultaneously.

- Ensures uniformity since each respondent is given the same set of questions.
- Frequently designed to score answers and compute an overall measure of respondent view and data.
- Facilitates anonymity, which may enhance response rates and encourage honest experience.

[3.2] METHODOLOGY:

(A)RESEARCH DESIGN:

This mixed-methods study explores deceptive skincare endorsements and ethical issues among 200 young women in Ahmedabad. Quantitative data will be collected through a survey regarding exposure, purchase behavior, and ethical concerns, while qualitative data will be collected through focus groups on perceptions, emotions, and ethical considerations. Both datasets will be analyzed separately (statistically and thematically) and then integrated to provide a comprehensive understanding of the issue.

(B) DATA COLLECTION METHOD:

1. Online Surveys:

Online surveys are the most efficient and cost-effective way to research deceptive skincare endorsements and ethical concerns among young women in Ahmedabad. Platforms such as Google Forms, SurveyMonkey, or Type form allow for easy questionnaire creation and distribution. These platforms are cost-effective as they save printing costs, reach a broad audience and collect data rapidly, and provide built-in analysis tools. Most importantly, they support mobile-friendly design, which is essential for reaching young people. For this specific topic, incorporating visual elements and using branching logic may make it more engaging and relevant. Finally, ethical considerations should be explicitly mentioned in the online survey itself, such as informed consent and anonymity.

2. Data analysis

Data from Google Form was transferred in table format from pie chart and bar graphs, then entered to Excel. In Excel, statistical tests were used to find results. Finally, responses were interpreted, results presented, and conclusions drawn.

- Spearman's Rank Correlation: Spearman's rank correlation is a statistical method for measuring the strength. It can measure the direction of a relationship between two variables on an ordered scale. Furthermore, there is also Spearman's rank correlation coefficient.
- Hypothesis Test 5: Hypothesis testing is a tool that can be defined as a statistical tool that reports on the significance of results of an experiment. This involves formulating a null hypothesis and an alternative hypothesis. This pair of hypotheses will always be mutually exclusive.

(3.3). QUESTIONNAIRE

Topic: Deceptive endorsements of skincare products causing ethical concerns amongst female youth in Ahmedabad.

Part-A:

Name: _____

Age: _____

Gender: _____

Part-B:

➤ **How do deceptive endorsements affect the youth's perception of skincare products?**

- a) They make youth more skeptical of all products
- b) They create unrealistic beauty standards
- c) They encourage natural skincare practices
- d) They increase consumer awareness

➤ **From whom do you come to know about any new skincare product?**

- a) Family
- b) Friends
- c) Colleagues
- d) Classmates
- e) Relatives

➤ **On which social media do you see the most endorsements of skincare products.**

- a) YouTube
- b) Instagram
- c) Facebook
- d) Telegram

➤ **What type of endorsement do young female consumers often trust the most?**

- a) Celebrity endorsements
- b) Influencer and peer recommendations
- c) Dermatologist endorsements
- d) Traditional media ads

➤ **What factors influence your decision to buy a skincare product of a particular company?**

- a) Personal experience

b) Influencer's credibility

c) Reviews from other users

d) Promotional offers

➤ **Have you ever been deceived by any endorsement of skincare products?**

a) Yes

b) No

➤ **In which type of skincare product did you experience the deception?**

a) Whitening cream

b) Face pack

c) Anti – aging cream

d) Dark circle cream

e) Others

➤ **What side effects or problems did you face?**

a) No positive change

b) Dryness

c) Acne vulgaris

d) Oily face

e) Rashes/ Burnout

f) Other

➤ **What steps did you take after experiencing above effects or problems?**

- a) Home remedy
- b) Consult Dermatologist
- c) Moving towards natural product
- d) Complain to customer support
- e) others

➤ **How much do you trust endorsements from skincare influencers?**

- a) Very trustworthy
- b) Somewhat trustworthy
- c) Neutral
- d) Not trustworthy

➤ **Do you believe that influencers genuinely use the products they endorse?**

- a) Yes always
- b) Sometimes
- c) Rarely
- d) Never

➤ **How often do you think influencers oversell benefits of skincare products?**

- a) Very often
- b) Sometimes
- c) Rarely
- d) Never

➤ **Have you ever felt misled by an influencer's endorsement?**

- a) Yes
- b) No

➤ **How concerned are you about ethical issues in influencer endorsements of a skincare product.**

- a) Very concerned
- b) Somewhat concerned
- c) Neutral
- d) Not Concerned

➤ **Have you ever read disclaimers or disclosure on influencer's post?**

- a) Yes
- b) No

➤ **Have you ever noticed any patterns in deceptive endorsements among specific influencer demographics?**

a) Yes

b) No

➤ **How likely are you to purchase a skincare product of a company after seeing its endorsement?**

a) Very likely

b) Somewhat likely

c) Neutral

d) Unlikely

➤ **Should officials of deceptive skincare endorsements face consequences for misleading endorsements?**

a) Yes

b) No

c) Unsure

➤ **Do you think deceptive endorsements by one harm the credibility of all other endorsements?**

a) Yes

b) Not necessarily

c) No

➤ **Do you consult a dermatologist before using any skincare products?**

a) Yes

b) No

c) Sometimes

➤ **Have you experienced any of these side effects of skincare products?**

a) Rashes

b) Dryness

c) Burning sensation

d) Excessive itching

➤ **Have you ever reported such side effects to the company's customer care?**

a) Yes

b) No

➤ **Was the company's response/compensation satisfactory according to you?**

a) Fully satisfactory

b) Satisfactory

c) not satisfactory

d) No response

➤ **Do you ever check the success or efficacy of the skincare products through reviews before buying it?**

a) Yes

b) No

c) Yes, when it is a new product concept.

(3.4) LIMITATION:

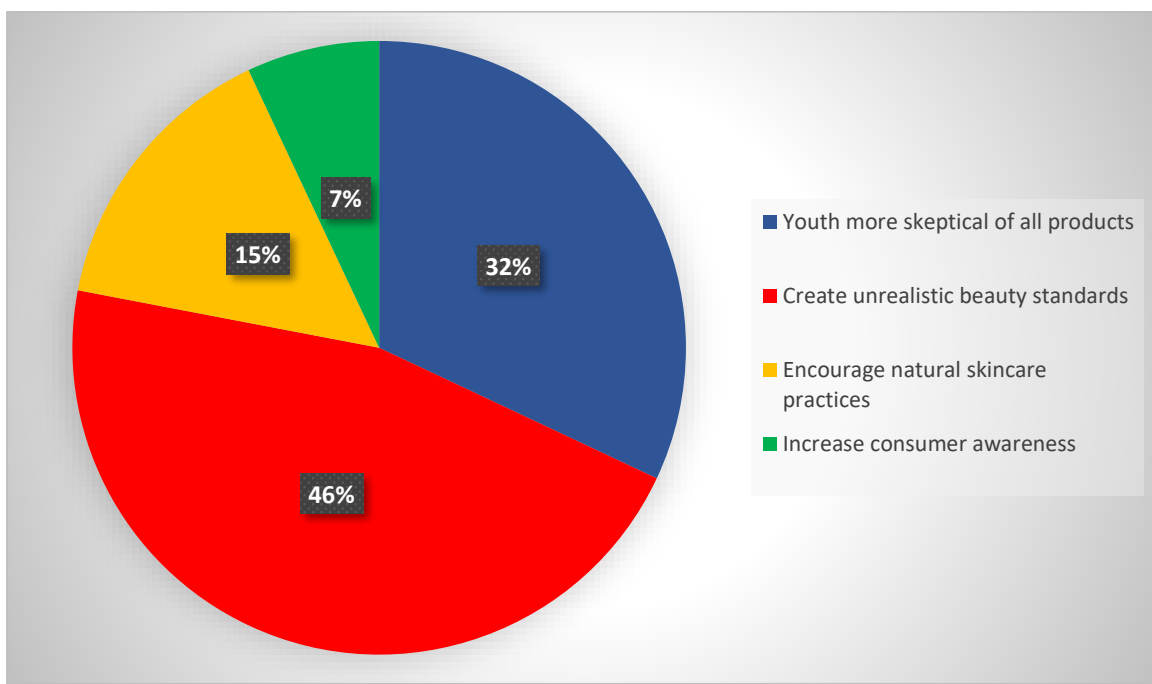
- However, some participants were unwilling to reveal information on their incomes, investment choices, and spending habits.
- The number of respondents surveyed for the project was limited to 200 women, which is a small portion of the total population of Ahmedabad City.
- Scope and sample size were limited to Ahmedabad City.
- The survey results could be biased by population motivation, availability, and willingness to respond.
- The data represent a small sample and may be inconclusive in finding out opinion of the population.
- They may have given incomplete or distorted information owing to their biases or comfort level in front of the interviewer.
- The survey results are unlikely to be representative of the whole scheme of other regions or another demographic beyond Ahmedabad.
- Time may have become a constraint, affecting the depth of responses which participants rendered.

CHAPTER IV: DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION

➤ **How do deceptive endorsements affect the youth's perception of skincare products?**

- They make youth more skeptical of all products
- They create unrealistic beauty standards
- They encourage natural skincare practices
- They increase consumer awareness

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Youth more skeptical of all products	64	32
Create unrealistic beauty standards	92	46
Encourage natural skincare practices	30	15
Increase consumer awareness	14	7



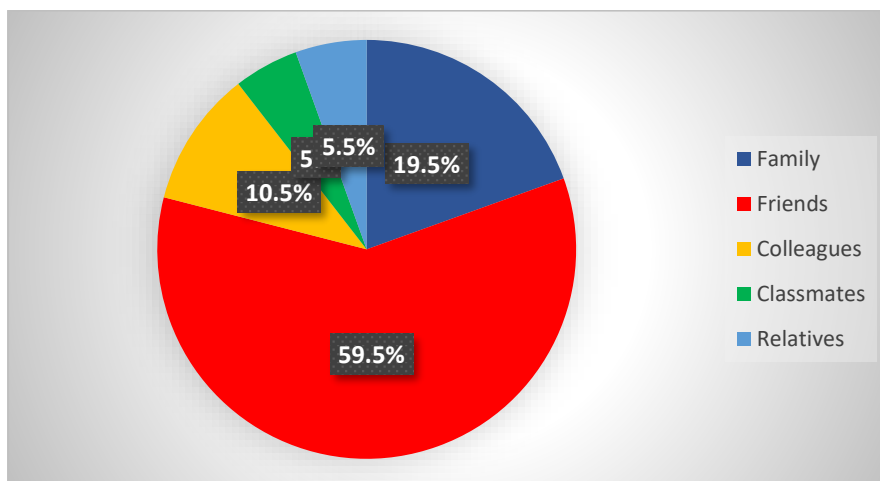
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 32% people say they make youth more skeptical all products, 46% people say they create unrealistic beauty standards, 15% people say they encourage natural skincare practices and only 7% people say they increase consumer awareness.

From whom do you come to know about any new skincare product?

- Family
- Friends
- Colleagues
- Classmates
- Relatives

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Family	39	19.5
Friends	119	59.5
Colleagues	21	10.5
Classmates	10	5
Relatives	11	5.5



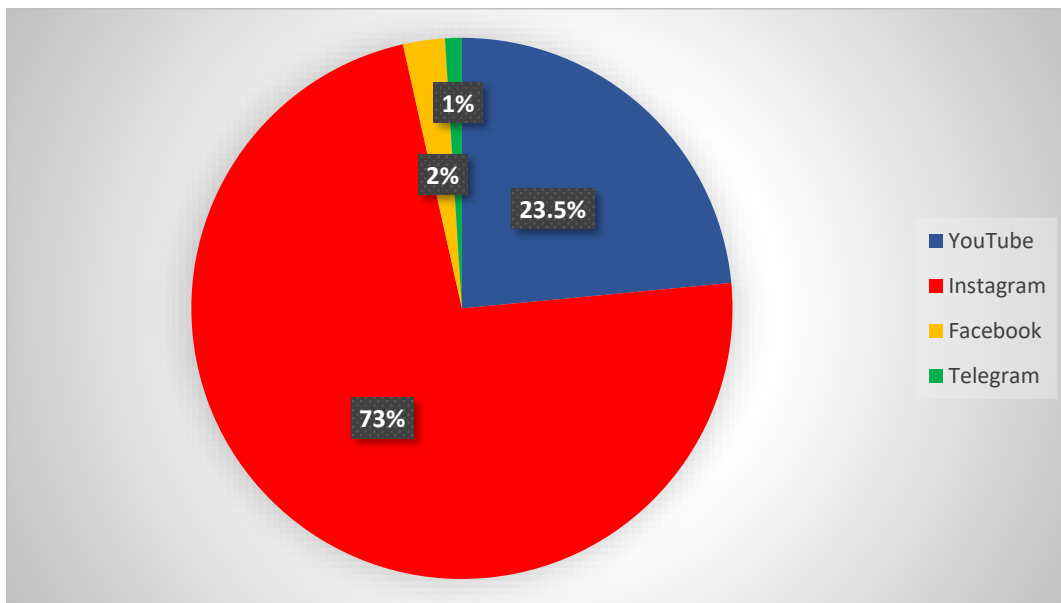
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 59.5% people from Family, 19.5% people from Friends, 10.5% people from Colleagues, 5% people from Classmates, 5.5% people from Relatives.

➤ **On which social media do you see the most endorsements of skincare products.**

- YouTube
- Instagram
- Facebook
- Telegram

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
YouTube	47	23.5
Instagram	146	73
Facebook	5	2.5
Telegram	2	1



INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that they see the most endorsements of skincare products on social media from 73% from Instagram, 23.5% from YouTube, 2% from Facebook and 1% from Telegram.

STATISTICAL ANALYSIS:

Solution:

- Is the proportion of endorsements seen on Instagram equal?

Step 1:

H_0 : Proportion of endorsements seen on Instagram and YouTube is equal. [$P_1 = P_2$]

H_1 : Proportion of endorsements seen on Instagram is more than YouTube. [$P_1 > P_2$]

Step2: Test Statistic under H_0

$$Z_{cal} = \frac{p_1 - p_2}{\sqrt{PQ \left(\frac{1}{n_1} + \frac{1}{n_2} \right)}}$$

Where $p_1 = \frac{146}{200} = 0.73$ and $p_2 = \frac{43}{200} = 0.215$ &

$$P = \frac{146+43}{200+200} = 0.5 \text{ and } Q = 1 - P$$

$$= 1 - 0.5$$

$$= 0.5$$

$$= \underline{0.73 - 0.215}$$

$$\sqrt{(0.5)(0.5) \left(\frac{1}{200} + \frac{1}{200} \right)}$$

$$= \underline{0.515}$$

$$\sqrt{(0.25)(0.005 + 0.005)}$$

$$= \frac{0.515}{0.00625}$$

$$Z_{cal} = 0.205412$$

Step 3:

Level of significance at $\alpha = 5\%$

Step 4:

At $\alpha = 5\%$ for (RTT) the value of $|Z_{tab}| = 1.65$

Step 5:

Decision

$$|Z_{tab}| < |Z_{cal}|$$

H_0 is rejected

H_1 is accepted

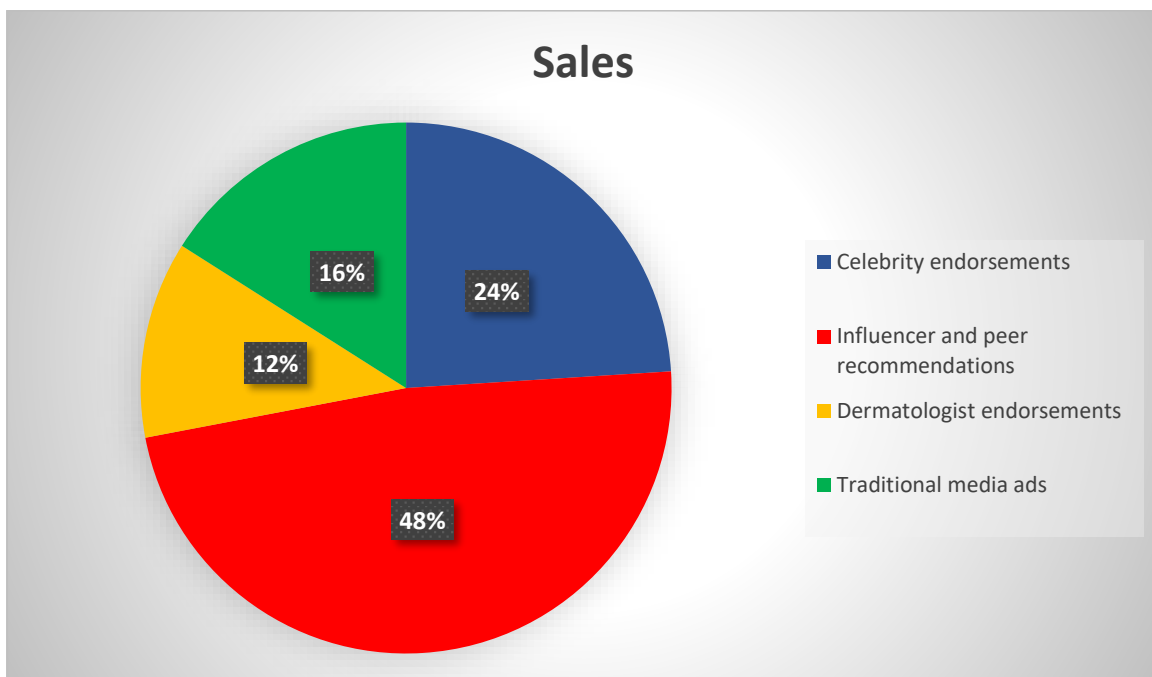
INTERPRETATION:

Here H_0 is rejected that means proportion of endorsement seen on Instagram is more than YouTube which suggests that the sample data provides strong evidence against null hypothesis, suggesting that the true proportion is different from the sample proportion.

➤ **What type of endorsement do young female consumers often trust the most?**

- Celebrity endorsements
- Influencer and peer recommendations
- Dermatologist endorsements
- Traditional media ads

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Celebrity endorsements	48	24
Influencer and peer recommendations	96	48
Dermatologist endorsements	24	12
Traditional media ads	32	16



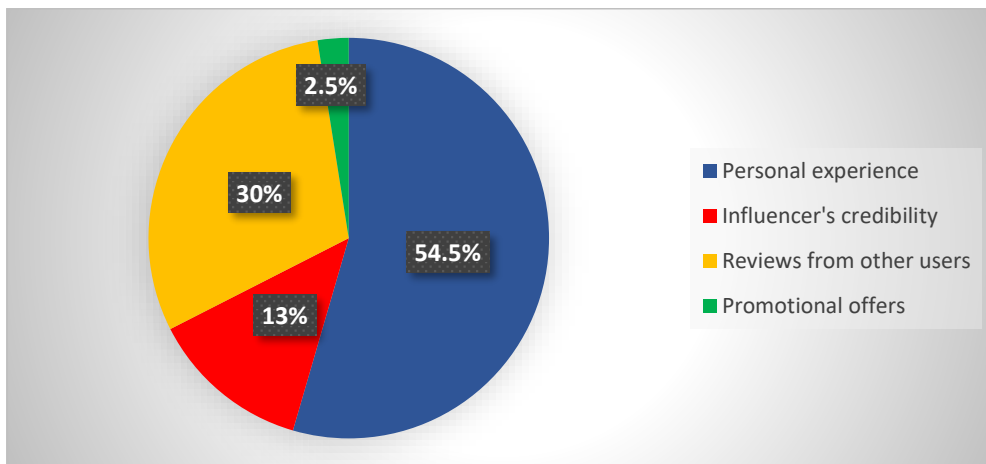
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 24% people say Celebrity endorsements, 48% people say influencer and peer recommendations, 12% people say Dermatologist endorsements and 16% traditional media ads.

➤ **What factors influence your decision to buy a skincare product of a particular company?**

- Personal experience
- Influencer's credibility
- Reviews from other users
- Promotional offers

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Personal experience	109	54.5
Influencer's credibility	26	13
Reviews from other users	60	30
Promotional offers	5	2.5



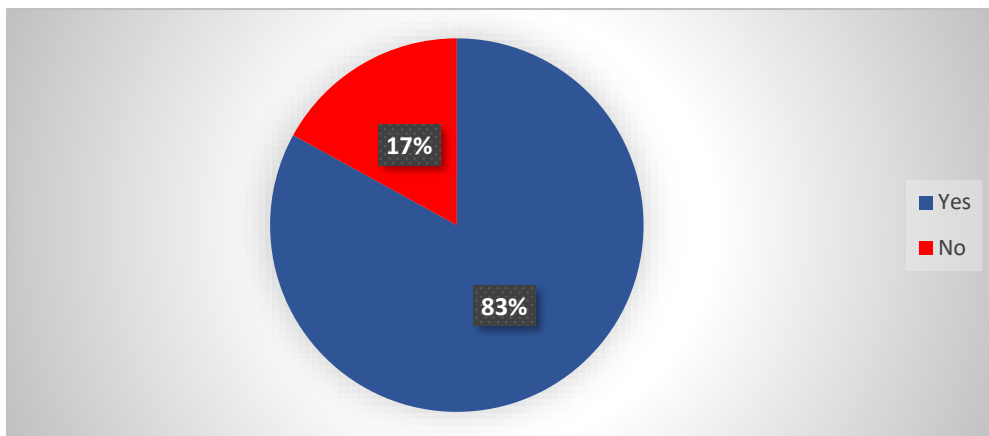
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that factors influence your decision to buy a skincare product of a particular company from 54.5% Personal experience, 13% Influencer's credibility, 30% Reviews from other users and 2.5% Promotional offers.

➤ **Have you ever been deceived by any endorsement of a skincare product**

- Yes
- No

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Yes	166	83
No	34	17



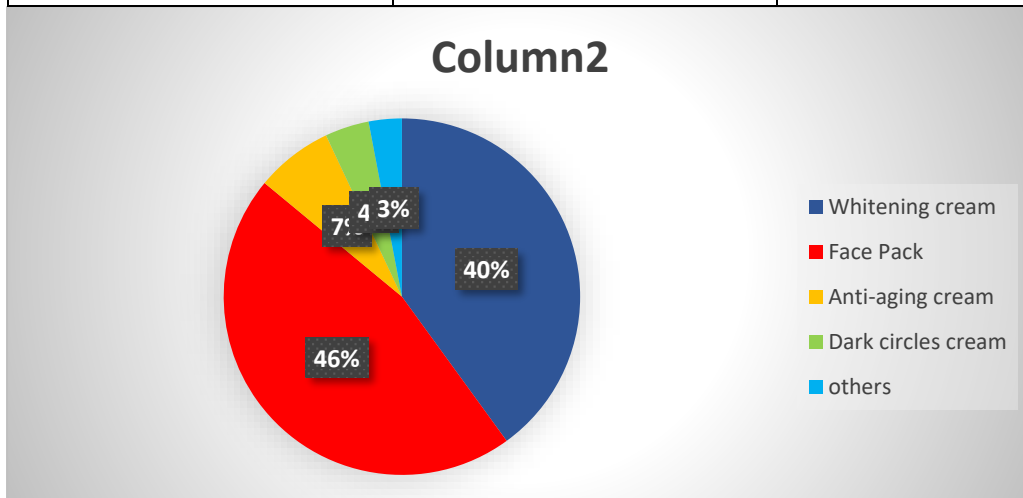
INTERPRETATION :

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 83% people experienced deception in skincare product and 17% people have not experienced any deception.

➤ **In which type of skincare product did you experience the deception?**

- Whitening cream
- Face pack
- Anti- aging cream
- Dark circle cream
- Others

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Whitening cream	80	40
Face pack	92	46
Anti -aging cream	14	7
Dark circles cream	8	4
others	6	3



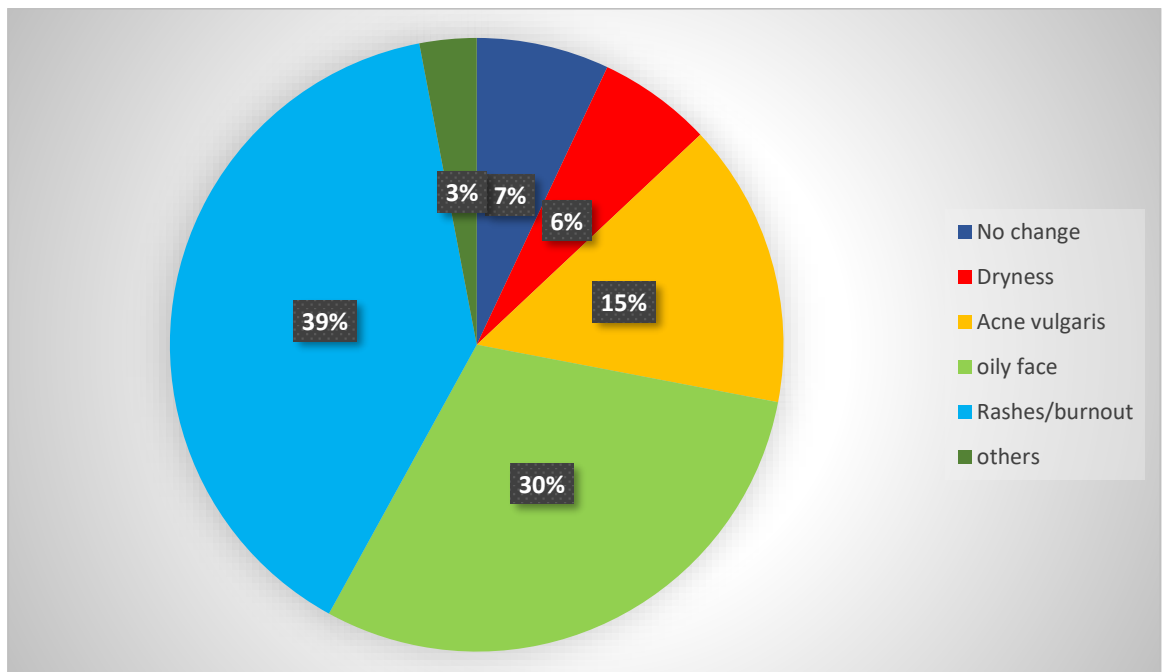
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 40% people experienced deception in whitening cream, 46% people from face pack, 7% people from anti-aging cream, 4% people from dark circle cream and 3% people from others.

➤ **What side effects or problems did you face?**

- No positive change
- Dryness
- Acne vulgaris
- Oily face
- Rashes/ Burnout
- Other

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
No positive Change	14	7
Dryness	12	6
Acne vulgaris	30	15
Oily face	60	30
Rashes/burnout	78	39
other	6	3



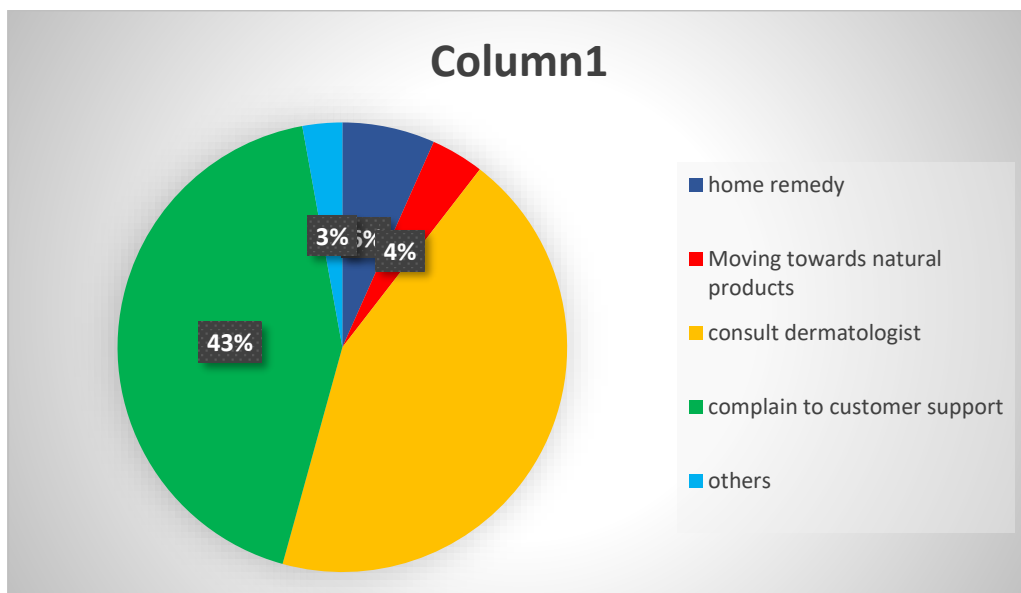
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 40% people experienced deception in whitening cream, 46% people from face pack, 7% people from anti-aging cream, 4% people from dark circle cream and 3% people from others.

➤ **What steps did you take after experiencing above effects or problems?**

- Home remedy
- Consult Dermatologist
- Moving towards natural product
- Complain to customer support
- others

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Home remedy	14	7
Consult Dermatologist	86	43
Moving towards natural product	4	2
Complain to customer support	90	45
others	6	3



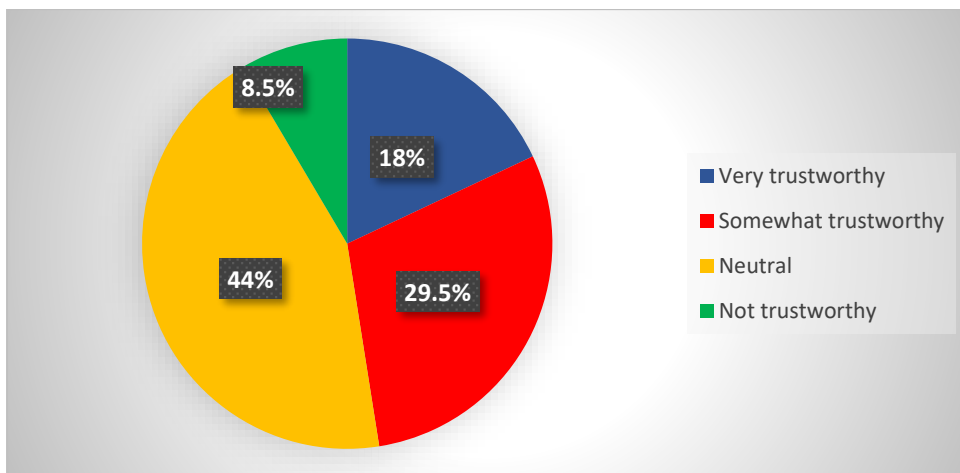
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 7% people prefer only home remedy, 43% consult dermatologist, 2% people only move towards natural products, 45% people complain to customer support and only 3% chose other way.

➤ **How much do you trust endorsements from skincare influencers?**

- Very trustworthy
- Somewhat trustworthy
- Neutral
- Not trustworthy

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Very trustworthy	36	18
Somewhat trustworthy	59	29.5
Neutral	88	44
Not trustworthy	17	8.5



INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret 18% people Very trustworthy, 29.5% people Somewhat trustworthy, 44% people Neutral and 8.5% people Not trustworthy.

STATISTICAL ANALYSIS:

SOLUTION:

- Is there any correlation between consumer's trust on endorsements and on skincare influencers?

Name	Count	Response
Very trustworthy	1	36
Somewhat trustworthy	2	59
Neutral	3	88
Not trustworthy	4	17

Correlation Matrix

	Column 1	Column 2
Column 1	1	
Column 2	-0.200	1

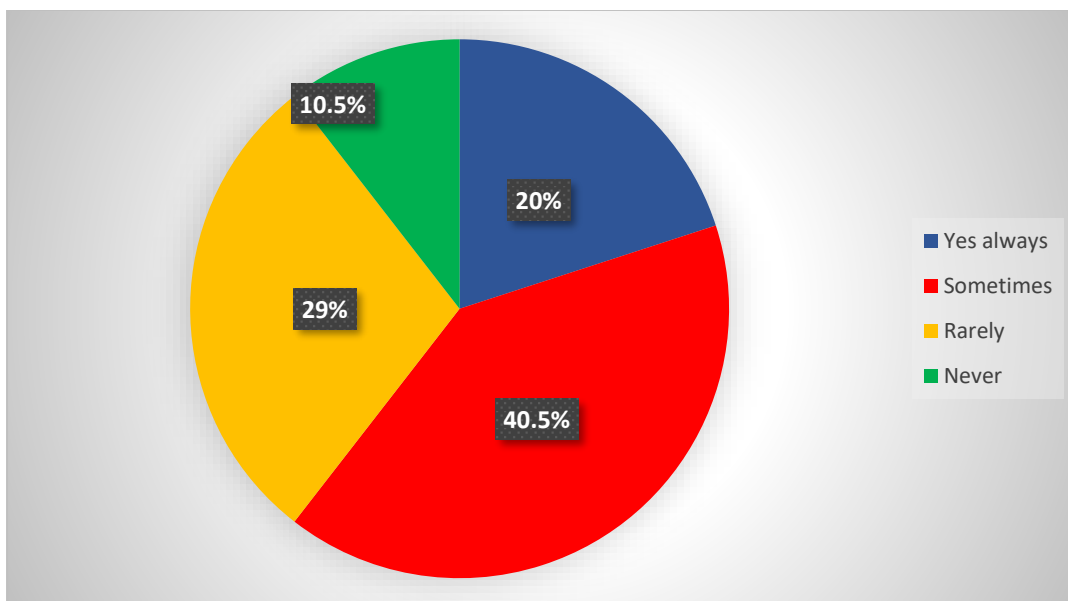
INTERPRETATION:

There is weak negative correlation between consumer's trust on endorsements and on skincare influencers. By this statistical analysis we can conclude that consumer's rarely trust the endorsements but they have considerable faith on skincare influencers. Therefore the problem to be noted is that there is lack of trust on the part of consumers.

➤ **Do you believe that influencers genuinely use the products they endorse?**

- Yes always
- Sometimes
- Rarely
- Never

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Yes always	40	20
Sometimes	81	40.5
Rarely	58	29
Never	21	10.5



INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 20% people say yes always, 40.5% people say sometimes, 29% people say rarely and 10.5% people say never.

STATISTICAL ANALYSIS:

SOLUTION:

- Is there any correlation between products influencers endorse and products they use?

Name	Count	Response
Yes always	1	40
Sometimes	2	81
Rarely	3	58
Never	4	21

Correlation Matrix

	Column 1	Column 2
Column 1	1	
Column 2	-0.400	1

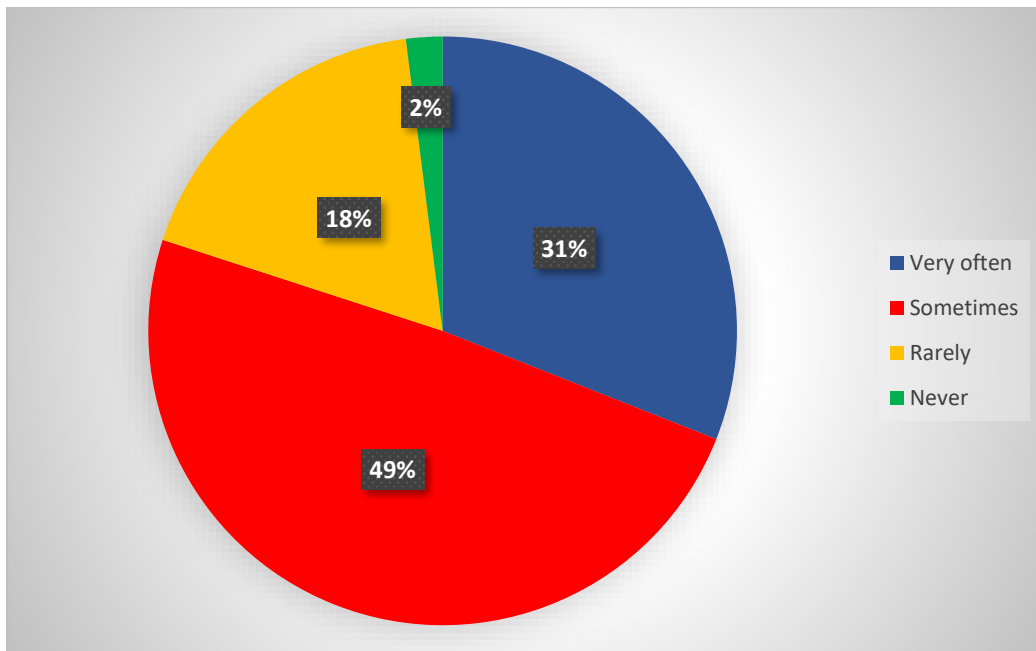
INTERPRETATION:

There is moderate negative correlation between products they endorse and the products they use. By this statistical analysis we can conclude that not all influencers use the products they endorse. Upon this we can say that there are deceptive endorsements going on in the skincare industry as not all the influencers use the products they endorse. When the influencers themselves do not use the products they endorse, this shows lack of self-trust on the product they endorse.

➤ **How often do you think influencers oversell benefits of skincare products?**

- Very often
- Sometimes
- Rarely
- Never

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Very often	62	31
Sometimes	98	49
Rarely	36	18
Never	4	2

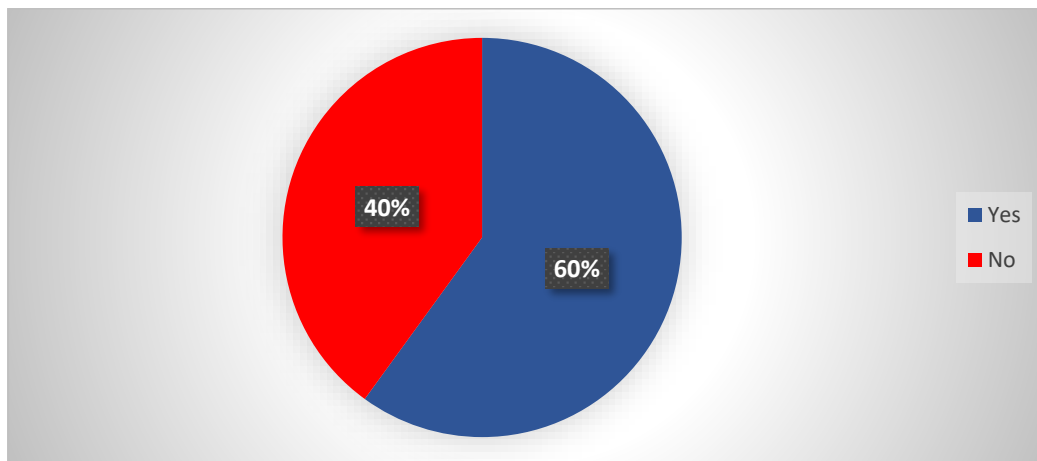


INTERPRETATION: Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 31% people say very often, 49% people say sometimes, 18% people say rarely and 2% people say never.

➤ **Have you ever felt misled by an influencer's endorsement?**

- Yes
- No

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Yes	120	60
No	80	40



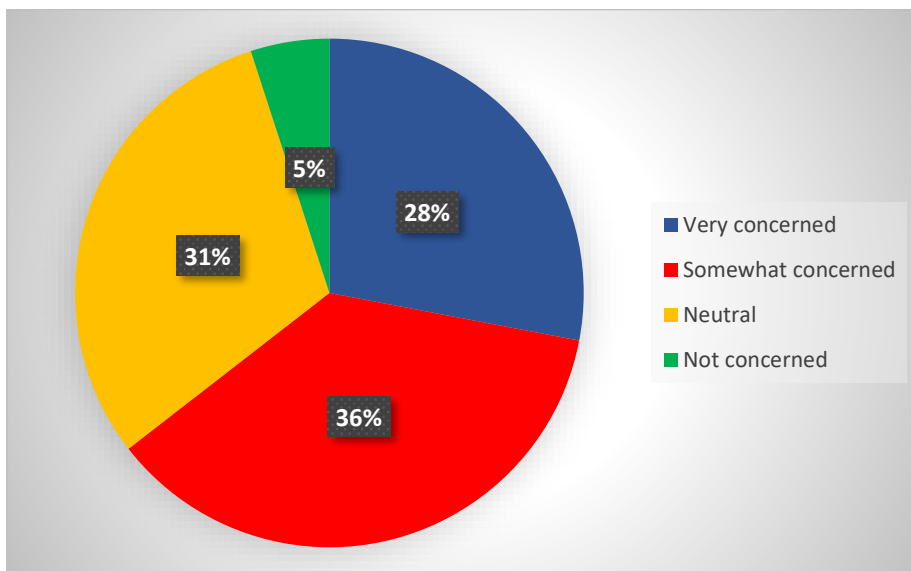
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 60% people are say yes and 40% people say no.

➤ **How concerned are you about ethical issues in influencer endorsements of a skincare product?**

- Very concerned
- Somewhat concerned
- Neutral
- Not Concerned

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Very concerned	56	28
Somewhat concerned	73	36.5
Neutral	61	30.5
Not concerned	10	5

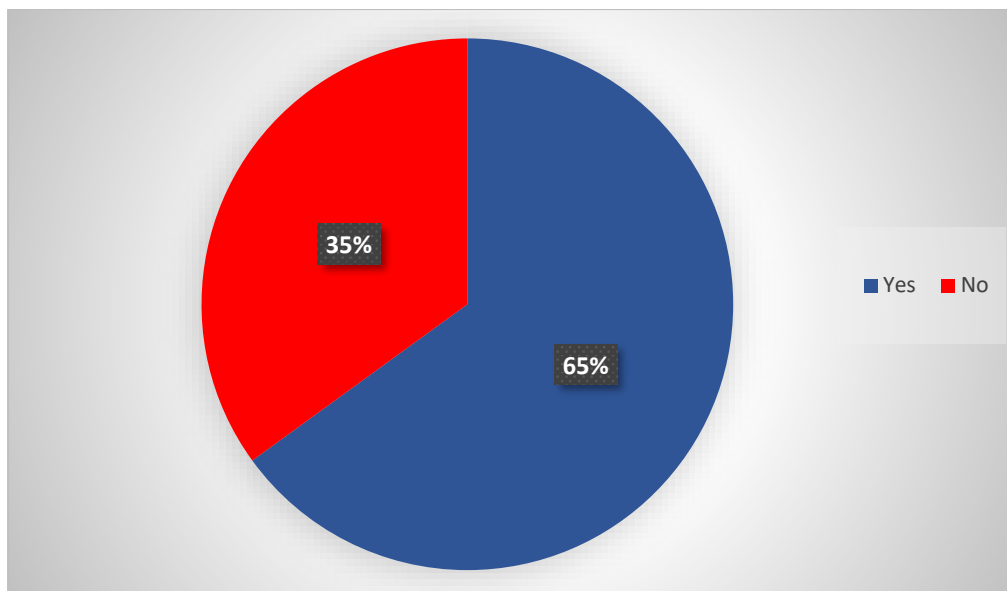


INTERPRETATION: Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 28% very concerned, 36% somewhat concerned, 31% neutral and 5% not concerned.

➤ **Have you ever read disclaimers or disclosure on influencer's post?**

- Yes
- No

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Yes	70	65
No	130	35



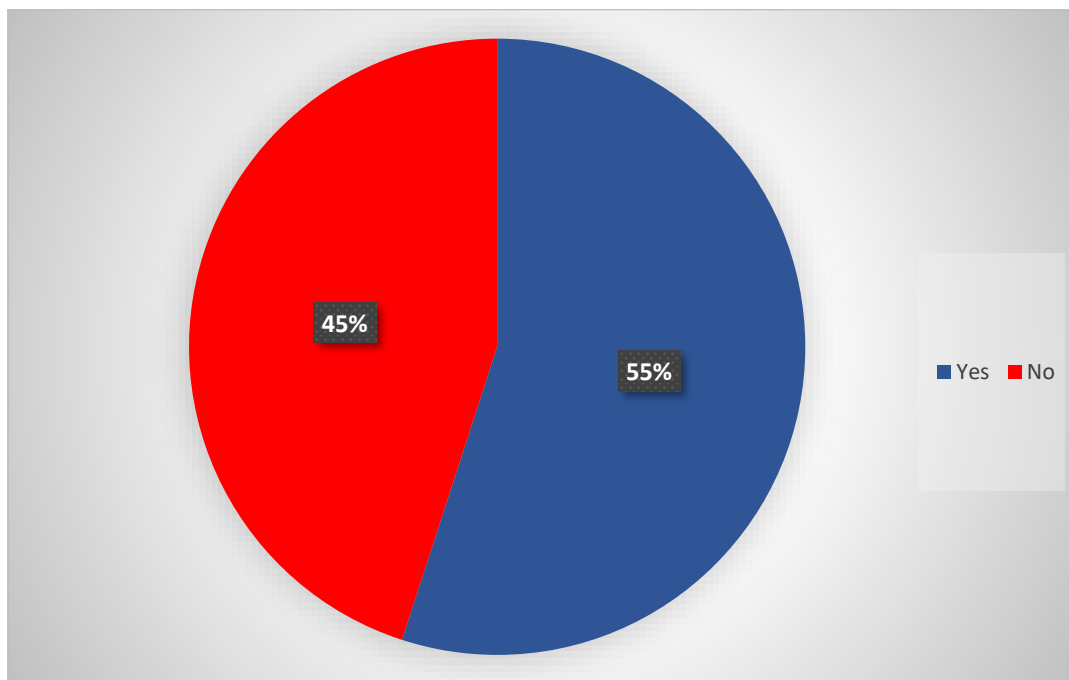
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 65% people read disclaimer and 35% people do not read disclaimer on influencer's post.

➤ **Have you ever noticed any patterns in deceptive endorsement among specific influencer demographics?**

- Yes
- No

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Yes	110	55
No	90	45



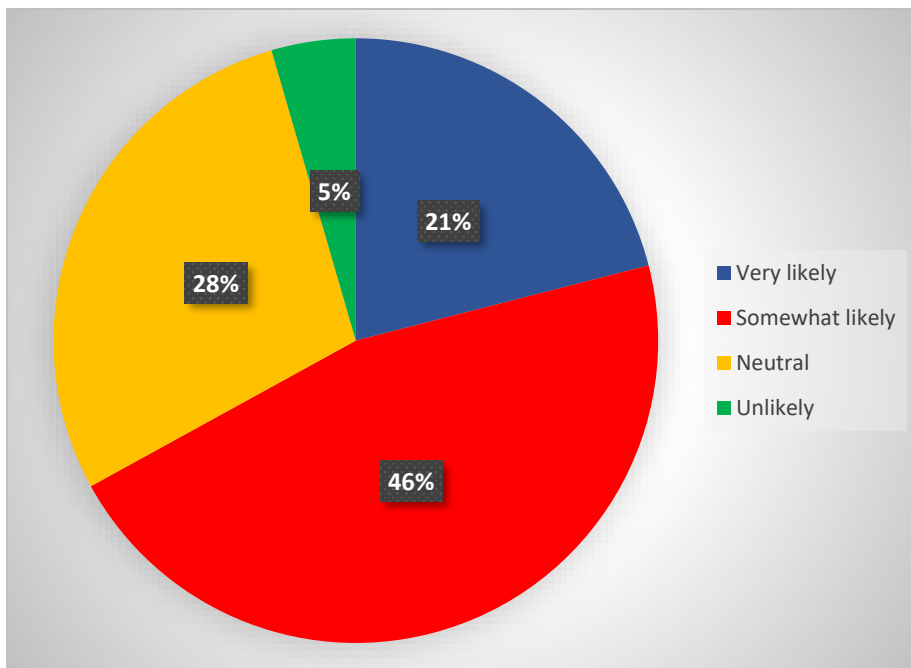
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 55% noticed any patterns in deceptive endorsements and 45% did not noticed any patterns.

➤ **How likely are you to purchase a skincare product of a company after seeing its endorsement?**

- Very likely
- Somewhat likely
- Neutral
- Unlikely

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Very likely	42	21
Somewhat likely	92	46
Neutral	57	28.5
Unlikely	9	4.5



INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 21% people are very likely, 46% somewhat likely, 28% neutral and 5% are unlikely to purchase a skincare product after seeing its endorsement.

STATISTICAL ANALYSIS:

SOLUTION:

- Is there any correlation between seeing an endorsement and consumers purchasing that product?

Particulars	Count	Responses
Very likely	1	42
Somewhat likely	2	92
Neutral	3	57
Unlikely	4	9

Correlation Matrix

	Column 1	Column 2
Column 1	1	
Column 2	-0.400	1

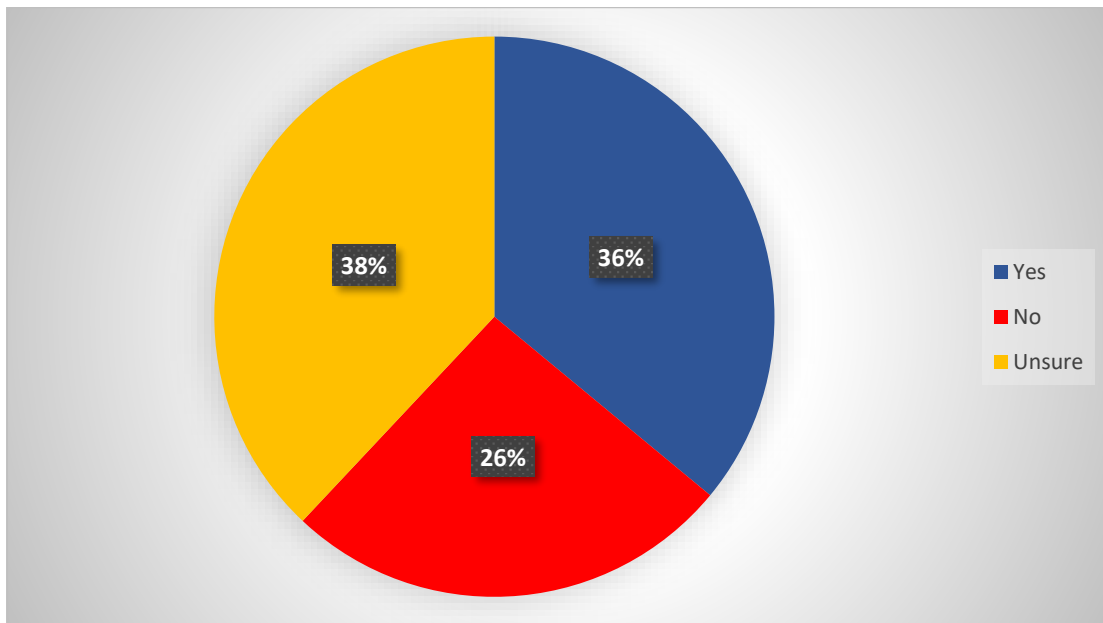
INTERPRETATION:

There is moderate negative correlation between seeing an endorsement and consumers purchasing that product. By this statistical analysis we can conclude that after seeing an endorsement partial consumer's purchase that product which has been endorsed. Therefore, we can say that claims and information given by the endorser is not that convincing that all consumers or significant consumer's purchase that product.

➤ **Should officials of deceptive skincare endorsement face consequences for misleading endorsement?**

- Yes
- No
- Unsure

Particulars	Responses	Percentage (%)
Yes	72	36
No	52	26
Unsure	76	38



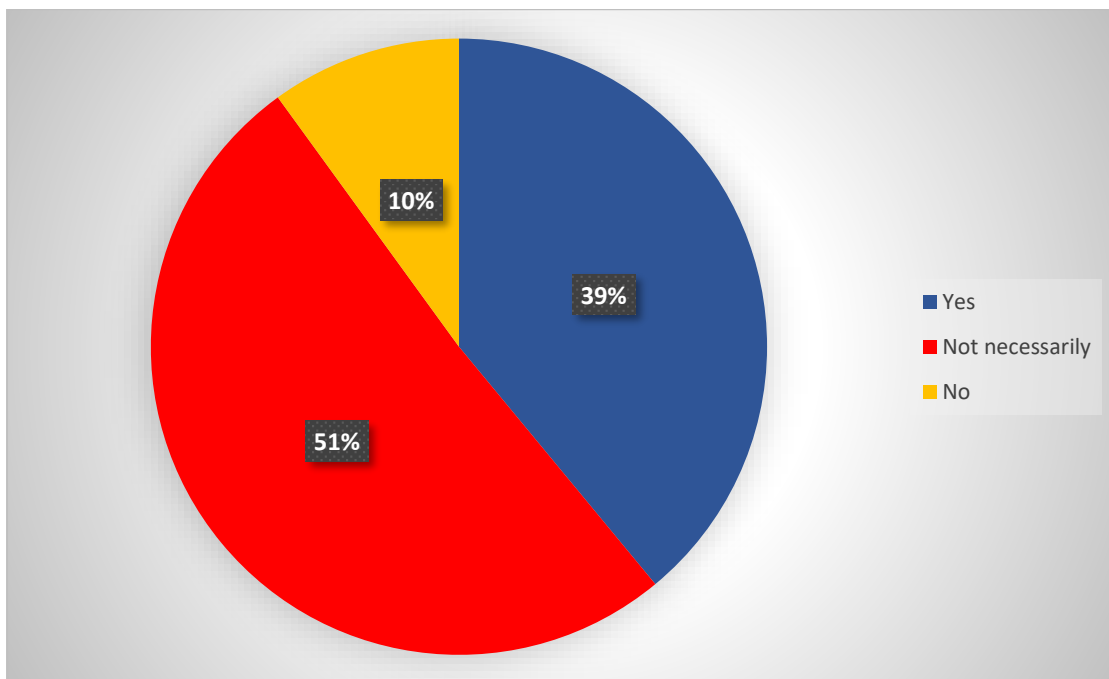
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 36% people say yes, 26% people say no and 38% people are unsure.

➤ **Do you think deceptive endorsements by one harm the credibility of all other endorsements?**

- Yes
- Not necessarily
- No

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Yes	78	39
Not necessarily	102	51
No	20	10



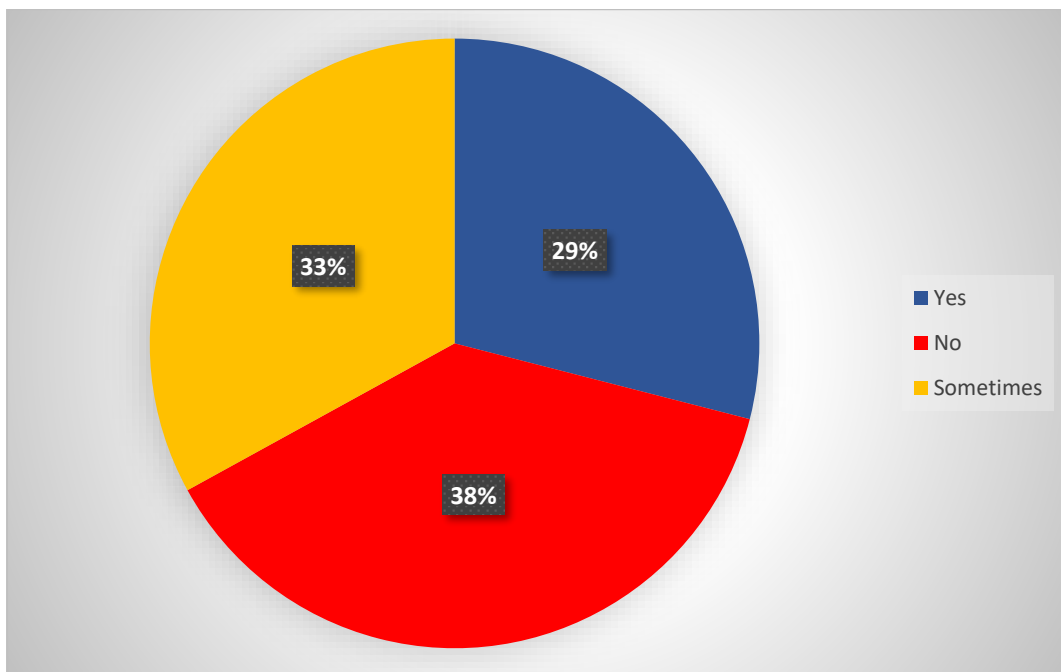
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 39% people say yes, 51% people say not necessarily and 10% people are say no.

➤ **Do you consult a dermatologist before using any skincare products?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Sometimes

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Yes	58	29
No	76	38
Sometimes	66	33



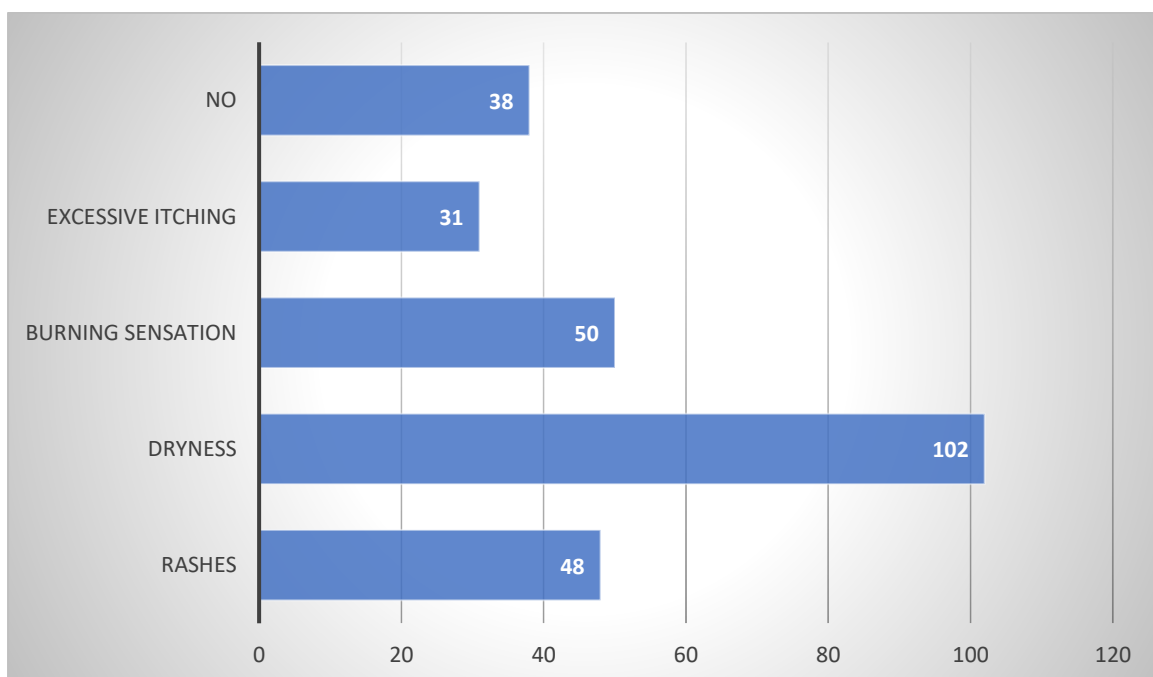
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 29% people say yes, 38% people say no and 33% people say sometimes.

➤ **Have you any experienced any of this side effects of skincare products?**

- Rashes
- Dryness
- Burning sensation
- Excessive itching

Particulars	Responses	Percentage(%)
Rashes	48	24
Dryness	102	51
Burning sensation	50	25
Excessive itching	31	16
No	38	19



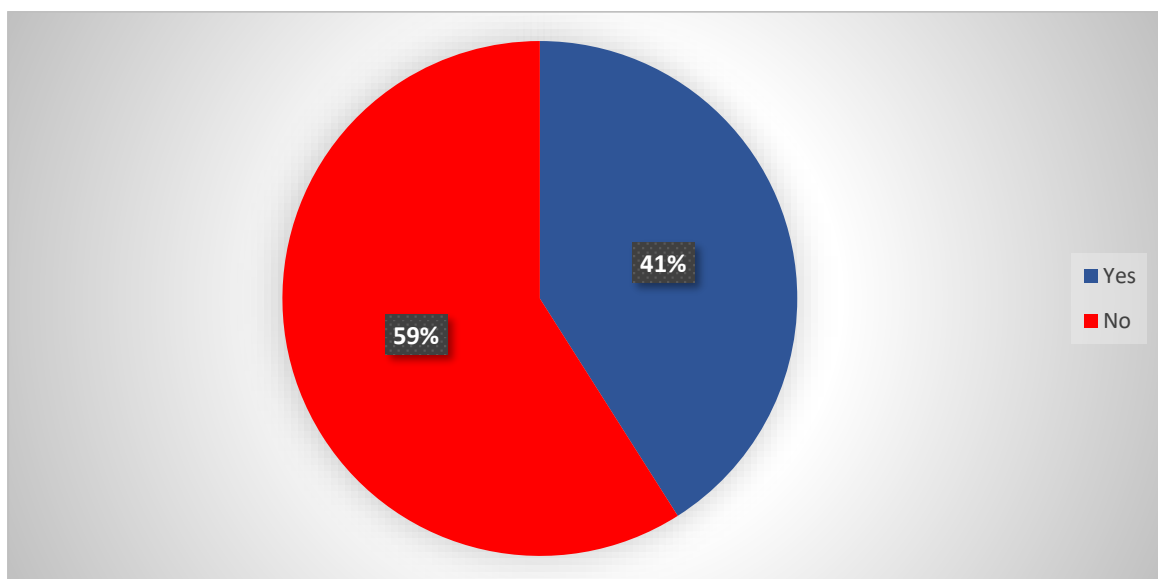
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 102 respondents experienced dryness and 50 respondents experienced a burning sensation 48 respondents experienced rashes, 38 respondents doesn't experienced side effects and 31 respondents excessive itching.

➤ **Have you ever reported such side effects to the company's customer care?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Particulars	Responses	Percentage
Yes	82	41
No	118	59



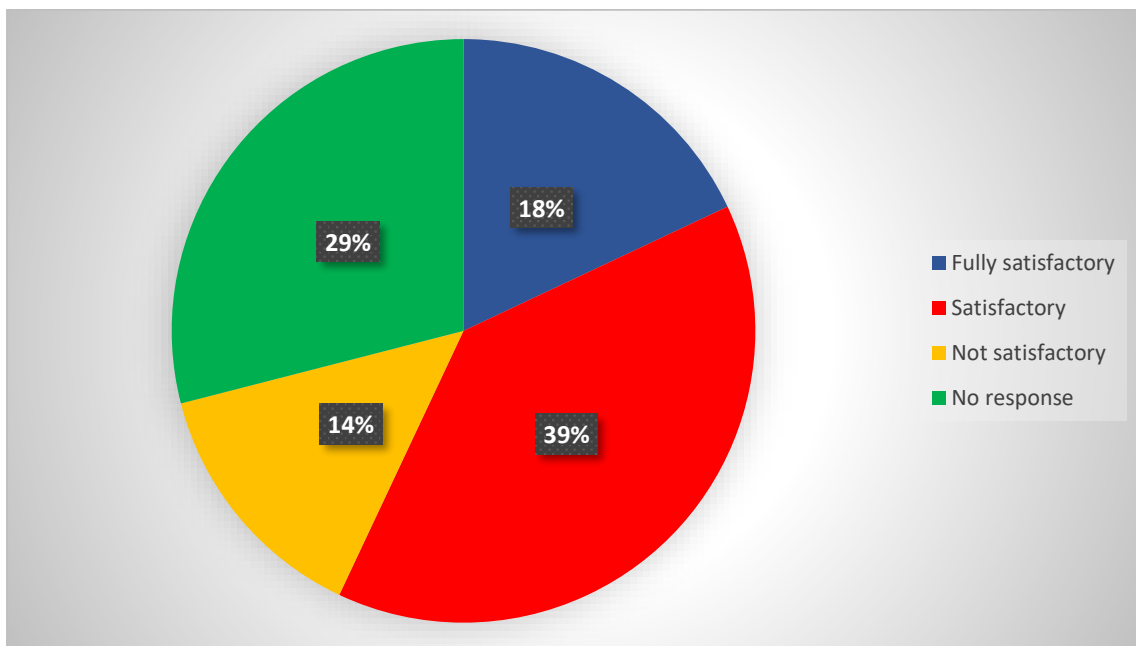
INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 41% people say yes and 59% people say no.

➤ **Was the company's response/compensation satisfactory according to you?**

- Fully satisfactory
- Satisfactory
- not satisfactory
- No response

Particulars	Responses	Percentage
Fully satisfactory	36	18
Satisfactory	78	39
Not satisfactory	28	14
No response	58	29

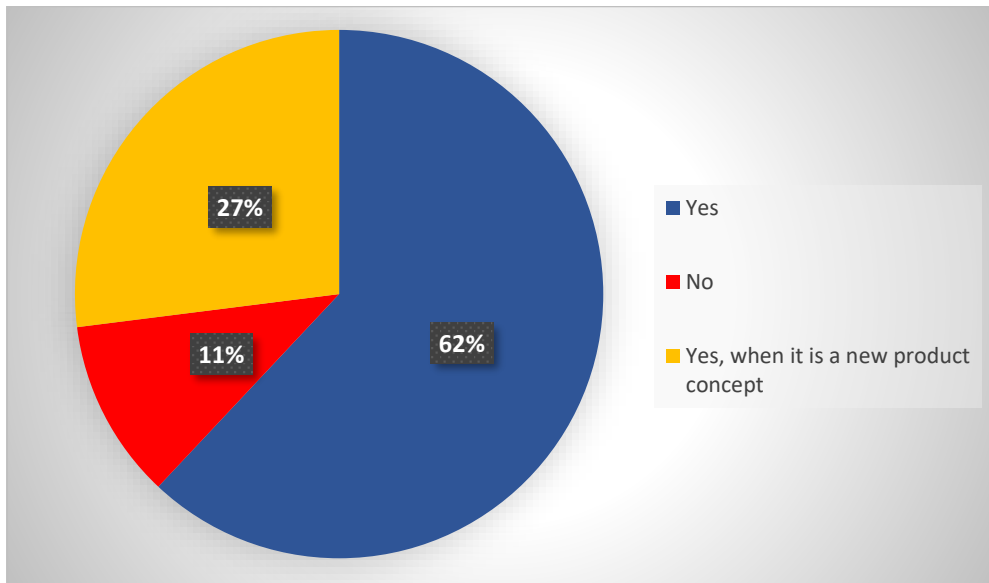


INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 18% people are fully satisfactory, 39% people are satisfactory, 14% people are not satisfactory and 29% people are no response.

- **Do you ever check the success or efficacy of the skincare products through reviews before buying it?**
- Yes
 - No
 - Yes, when it is a new product concept.

Particulars	Responses	Percentage
Yes	124	62
No	22	11
Yes, when it is a new product concept	54	27



INTERPRETATION:

Above table and chart, we can see that number of people who respond and majority of it. From analysis we interpret that 62% people say yes, 11% people say no and 27% people say yes, when it is a new product concept.

CHAPTER V: FINDINGS AND CONCLUSION

[V] FINDINGS AND CONCLUSION

(5.1) FINDINGS

From the questionnaire the following points are to be noted:

- 100% respondents are females.
- In this study it is clear that all of the respondents are coming from age group 18-25.
- The study conclude that most of females are using face wash
- It is found that 50% women are fully satisfied with that(chosen brand) skincare brand.
- The study shows that 59% women knew about skincare products from their friends and rest are known from Family and Colleagues.
- Most of decision of buying skincare product of a company influence by their personal experience which is 54%.
- It is disclosed that 73% women are most endorsement of skincare products by using Instagram.
- 20% women believe that the influencers genuinely use the products they endorse.
- 65% of respondents are read disclaimer or disclosure on influencer's post.
- 55% respondents are noticed any patterns in deceptive endorsement among specific influencers demographic whereas 45% respondents are not noticing.

- In this study it is shows that half of respondents (59%) have not reported any side effects to the customer's care.
- Only 29% women are concerned a dermatologist before using any skincare products and 33% are sometimes concerned a dermatologist before using any skincare products.
- 18% respondents are fully satisfied with the company's response.
- 62% respondents are check the success or efficacy of the skincare products through reviews before buying it.

(5.2) CONCLUSION

In conclusion, the research on deceptive endorsement of skincare products highlights significant ethical concerns impacting female youth in Ahmedabad.

The study reveals that misleading advertisements, especially those featuring influencers, often create unrealistic beauty standards and compel young women to purchase products based on false claims. This not only affects their financial resources but also contributes to issues such as low self-esteem, body image anxiety, and mental health challenges.

Moreover, the lack of regulatory oversight on endorsements exacerbates the situation, allowing companies to exploit the vulnerability of young consumers. The findings underscore the need for heightened awareness of ethical marketing practices and the importance of critical consumer education. Promoting transparency in endorsements and contributes to issues such as low self-esteem, body image anxiety, and mental health challenges.

Moreover, the lack of regulatory oversight on endorsements exacerbates the situation, allowing companies to exploit the vulnerability of young consumers. The findings underscore the need for heightened awareness of ethical marketing practices and the importance of critical consumer education. Promoting transparency in endorsements and fostering a

culture of responsible advertising are essential steps in mitigating the negative effects of deceptive marketing within this demographic. Future initiatives should focus on empowering female youth with the tools to discern genuine product efficacy from misleading claims, ultimately contributing to healthier self-images and consumer habits.

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1) Escalas, J. E., & Bettman, J. R. (2003). "You Are What They Eat: The Influence of Reference Groups on Consumer Behavior." Journal of Consumer Research, 31(3), 510-523.

2) Williams, S., & Polonsky, M. (2006). "Marketing to the Vulnerable: Can Ethical Approaches Lead to Better Outcomes?" Journal of Business Ethics, 64(2), 189–202.

3) Choi, S. M., & Rifon, N. J. (2007). "Who Is the Celebrity in Advertising? Understanding Dimensions of Celebrity Endorsement." Journal of Popular Culture, 40(2), 304–324.

4) Desai, N., & Shah, P. (2019). "Colorism and Skincare Marketing: The Role of Fairness Products in India." International Journal of Advertising, 38(4), 513–531.

